

SPORTSWEEK

Almonte Gazette columnist

Silver says

By Charlie Kitts



It is entertainment — support it or lose it!...with very few exceptions professional sports events are entertainment to us Valley folks...the local exceptions of course are Wayne Giardino in pro football, Garry Galley and Trevor Timmins in pro hockey...none of us are compelled to attend any pro sports event for any other reason than a few hours of entertaining release...and we all have different tastes in the menu of opportunities presented to us...from WWF wrestling (I still think the late "Little Beaver" and Renfrews Larry Kasaboski provided better entertainment to the NHL Senators...the Riders are gone because Valley sports fans finally withdrew their support at the gate...the clowns in the front office were as entertaining as many of the same type on the field...we are now faced with two major franchises in the Valley — the Lynx and the Senators...at least two professional basketball leagues investigated the area but both were unprepared to go head to head with hockey...the Lynx need support!...they are "our team" in pro baseball...a great park with great atmosphere...baseball fans realize that players such as FP Santangelo and others often end up in the "big leagues"...they deserve our support...the Senators have also put a lid on front office nonsense and appear to be preparing a contender...they also have earned the support they need to be successful (spell that profitable)...if we don't support them they rapidly become part of Valley history, never to return...so, remember the words to that old song "take me out to the ball game".

Pakenham needs support also...local organizers for the Brain Tumour Foundation are holding their third annual fundraising dance Saturday, July 16...Max Keeping will be on hand to MC the evening...entertainers include Peter Bayford and "Wild Ride", "Big Picture", Mike Ryan, Davey Drummond and perennial supporters of Valley charities Ron and Jamie McMunn...Pakenham Community Centre is the place to be!...tickets available at Byrne Home Hardware.

Remember the Vincent's?...they used to operate the garage where Coady's Car Care is now!...okay, so it was the early 50s...and why do they come to mind at this time?...they ran "stock cars"...clunkers with few windows, roller bars inside, bright colours and big numbers on the side...they ran at the track at Landsdowne Park...what?...you don't remember the track that went around the football field?...bleachers on the south side?...big wooden fences behind the end zones?...lots of noise, not a lot of speed!...sort of like Gerry Bolton...okay, okay, the reason the whole idea comes to mind is the success our Canadian drivers are having on the world's tracks...Villeneuve a winner again on Sunday...Tracey and Moore highly ranked in Cart Racing and more to come...two thoughts come to mind...first, did it all start right here in the "Friendly Town" with the Vincents?...second, can you just imagine how good Canadian drivers would really be if they didn't have to practice in snow five months of every year?

A correction...in my haste to get to the fax in Cornwall last Monday, my handwriting suffered...the diminutive gentleman we all know and love as Cheezer had his proper name misspelled...the middle name is Parnel not Parmel as printed...it didn't bother the lad as much as it did a dozen others who wanted to see it corrected!

Valley Rally hits road on weekend

By Les Humphreys
Final preparations for the Hart "Valley Gold" Rally are now complete and a good crowd is expected. Bicyclists from as far away as Deep River and Toronto come to Almonte to enjoy the scenic rural byways of Lanark County, following maps and route instructions provided by the Almonte Bicycle Club.

Rides of 60, 100, 160 and 200 km. will be taking place on Saturday, July 19 starting from Almonte Arena at 9 a.m. for destinations ranging from Lanark to Sharbot Lake. After the ride there will be a barbecue in Ash-ton.

On Sunday, July 20, rides of 60, 80 and 110 km. will be heading for Pakenham, White Lake and Burnstown. While Saturday's rides are primarily for road bikes, Sunday features the 80 km. "California or Bust" mountain bike tour. This year marks the 11th anniversary of this event.

15km. time trial — Clayton Rd. — July 8

Rainclouds deterred all but Mick Pstross on this occasion. Mick rode alone to complete the ride in 30 min. 27 sec., although he has ridden faster on the Appleton Road Course, this is a good time for him on the hillier Clayton Road course. Officials outnumbered participants tonight, with Sharron and Mike Jeffers timekeeping and Bill Treusch at the turn.

40 km. Time Trial — July 13

Three club members entered the 40 km. Time Trial leg of the National Capital Triathlon, held in Carleton Place in conjunction with Mississippi River Days. On this Sunday morning, conditions were warm and the winds were calm. As the day wore on, temperatures soared into the 30s.

It was a hilly route, comprising the 8th line of Ramsay and Wolf Grove Road. The long climb up past Union Hall left riders with



Almonte Bicycle Club members Don Coleman, Denis Dube and Les Humphreys are shown together after completing the 40K time-trial competition at Carleton Place's Mississippi River Days on Sunday morning. The event was won by Keith Mahoney of Kanata in an impressive time of 1:02:10.

little in reserve for the fast return. Fastest performance was a 59 min. ride, by Ian Fraser, of Ottawa, in the second leg of the triathlon, which he went on to win.

Fastest in the Individual Time Trial was Keith Mahoney of Kanata, in 62 min. 10 sec. Les Humphreys was the first Almonte rider to finish, two minutes down, in 64 min. 58 sec., taking 3rd veteran spot and 4th overall.

Denis Dube, finished almost three minutes down

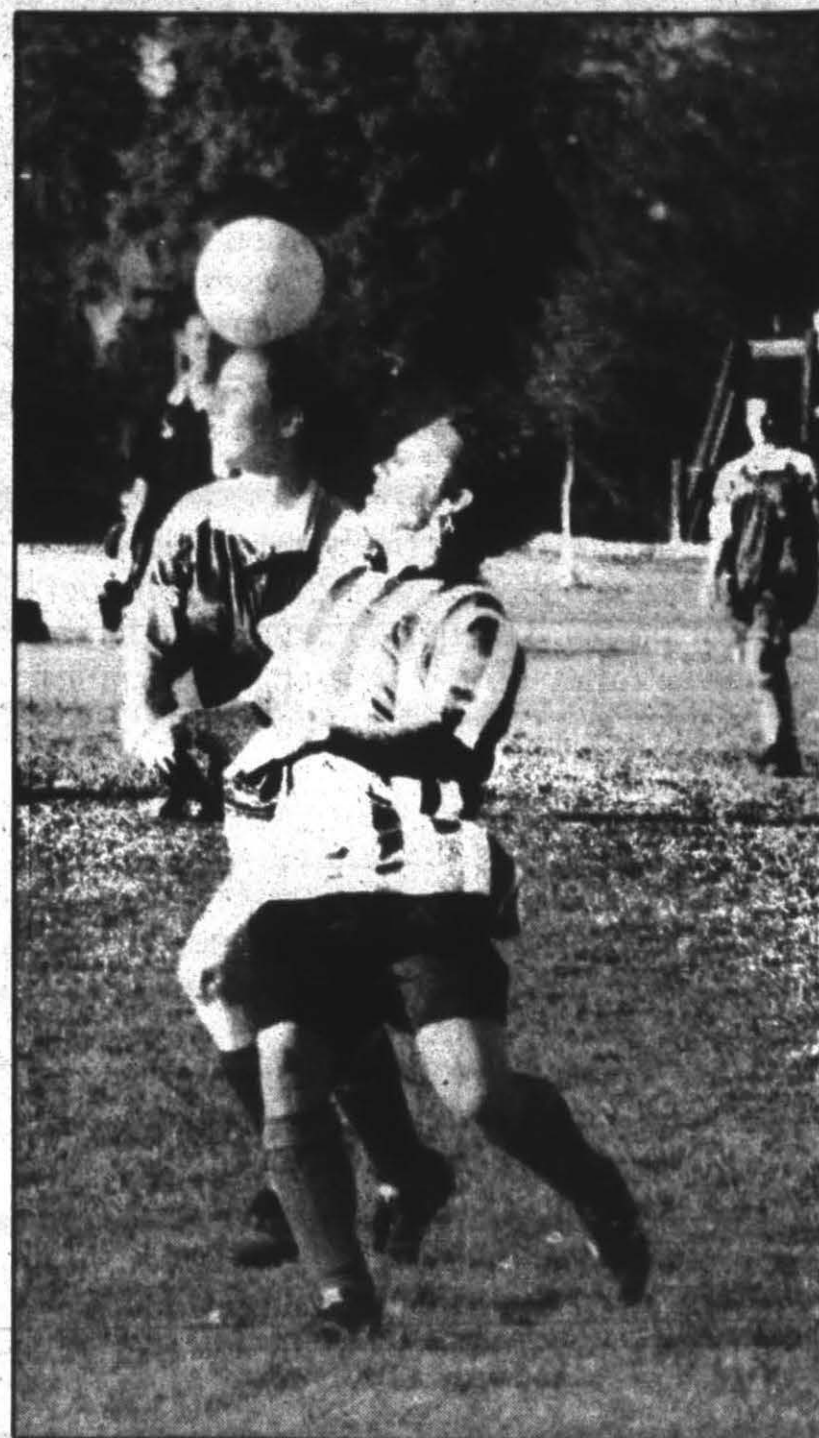
on Les, with a 67 min. 38 sec. ride, having veered off course near the start, losing two minutes before getting back on track. Denis took the silver medal for second senior and finished eighth overall. Don Coleman finished a minute and a half down on Denis in 69 min. for ninth spot.

Individual time trial performances were overshadowed by tri and duathlon splits, of which at least a dozen were in the 62 to 65 minute range.

Next week

Next week's 15 km. time trial takes place Tuesday, July 22 at 7 p.m. Course is Clayton Road, for a distance of 15 km. starting at Spirit Brewing. The next 40 km. event takes place Aug. 17 on Wolf Grove Road at 8 a.m.

Anyone interested in finding out more about these and other club activities should call Les Humphreys at 256-2498, John Warren at 256-3195 or Don Coleman at 257-2132.



Two local soccer teams battle it out in Gemmill Park last week.

Mudcats participated in league playdowns

By Jean Pye

Special to The Gazette
OTTAWA - The Mississippi Mudcat Majors participated in the Division 2 Little League Playdowns here July 12 and 13. The team is comprised of 11 and 12-year-old boys from Carleton Place, Almonte and Pakenham.

In the first game the Mudcats met a tough Glebe team and despite strong pitching by Kevin Silva and relief pitcher Tyler Scott, the local team went down to defeat 17-8.

The next game proved to be an exciting one against Arnprior. The first two innings ended in a scoreless tie, due in part to strong defensive play but especially to superb pitching by Matt Pierce. Singles were hit by Jamie Pelletier and Kevin Silva and a double by Ben Kelly. Cats first scoring opportunity came from a single by Matt Pierce who managed to steal home in an exciting play to make it 1-0 in the top of the third inning.

Arnprior tied it in the fourth, but a smart play by pitcher Pierce, stopped any further runs. After grounding the ball, Pierce faked the throw to first, then picked off the third base runner as he tried to steal home. Catcher, Kevin Silva then made an excellent throw to Jamie Pelletier at third base to again tag the runner and complete a double play.

Momentum took a turn for the worse in the bottom of the fifth. Strong hitting by Arnprior combined with a series of errors by the Mudcats did irreparable damage to the locals' spirits and their game. Pierce managed another strikeout to bring his game total to six. First baseman Ryan Howard came in to pitch and did an excellent job, striking out the next two batters. Unfortunately, our opponents came away with a total of eight runs in this inning and the score was now 9-1 Arnprior. Pierce led off with a double in the sixth but the offence was unable to continue and the game ended 9-1.

Team members who competed this weekend included: David MacDonald, John Pye, Andy Smith, Ben Kelly, Ryan Howard, Remi Caya, Matt Pierce, Tyler Scott, Jamie Pelletier, Kevin Silva and Tyler McCord.

Mudcats are to be congratulated for their hard work and sportsmanship as they met some very tough competition. Special thanks are extended to coaches Randy Pierce and John Pelletier and manager Phil McCord for their dedication and perseverance throughout the season. Their efforts were very much appreciated by the players and their parents.

Junior Mudcast lose two in Orleans

Junior Mudcats were in Orleans on the Canada Day weekend for their last tournament prior to the district playdowns. Unfortunately, the Mudcats found themselves in the toughest of the three divisions in the tournament. In the first game, they faced the Carlingwood Frank Ryan Cardinals.

The Cardinals proved to be a team with strong defense, solid pitching, and a potent offense. Mike Truelove pitched the first three innings for the Mudcats, and gave up 10 runs on six hits, three walks, one hit batter, two balks, and two wild pitches. Adam Bellefeuille pitched the fourth inning, and faced only three batters; striking out two of them.

The Mudcats only two runs came in the first inning. Dave Galway was hit by a pitch, stole second, and moved to third when Andrew Cochran reached first on an error by the Cardinal first baseman. Galway then stole home on a wild pitch, and Cochran moved to third. Truelove then hit a double to deep left field to score Cochran.

There were some fine defensive plays by the Mudcats. Tyler Bartlett made a

fine running catch in deep centre field, and catcher Dave Galway, first baseman Mike Truelove, and second baseman Jordan Purcell combined to pick off a cardinal runner at first and to get him out in a rundown. The final score was Cardinals 10, Mudcats 2.

In the second game, the Mudcats played the Orleans Red Sox. Andrew Cochran started on the mound and went two strong innings before leaving with a sore arm. Cochran has been bothered by arm problems this year, and the team hopes he heals quickly as he is one of the team's better pitchers. Cochran gave up two unearned runs on two walks, and errors by the third baseman and the right fielder.

In the bottom of the second, the Mudcats scored when Cochran walked, moved to second on a passed ball, went to third when Truelove grounded out to second, and scored on Purcell's single up the middle. In the

third, Chris Edwards was given the ball and got three quick outs, on a pop foul to Tim Smith, a fly ball to Jesse Lacroix in right field and a strikeout.

In the top of the fourth, the Red Sox led off with a single up the middle. With two out, the runner scored from second on an error by the second baseman. The Mudcats took the lead in the bottom of the fourth. Cochran and Truelove led off with back to back walks, and stole their way to second and third. Both runners scored when the Orleans second baseman booted Bartlett's ground ball. Edwards moved Bartlett to second on an infield hit. Back to back steals moved the runners to second and third. Bellefeuille singled to right, scoring Bartlett, and Edwards was out at the plate. The score at this point was Mudcats 4, Red Sox 3.

The top of the fifth was disastrous for the Mudcats. Edwards was chased from the mound when Orleans led off with five straight hits. Bellefeuille went in to relieve Edwards, but the first five batters in the inning all scored. Tyler

Bartlett made his first appearance as a pitcher for the team, and after giving up two runs in the sixth and an error by the third baseman, proceeded to pitch two strong innings. The final score was Red Sox 10, Mudcats 4.

It was encouraging to note that with the exception of the fourth inning, the Mudcats were in the game.

The Mudcat defense still needs to improve. The outfield does not always hit the cutoff man and in the two games, that resulted in four runs for the opposition. The infield still needs some work on ground balls. The infield committed six errors during the two games. The fans can see an improvement from week to week, and the team should be ready to give a good performance when the district playdowns start in two weeks.

On June 30, the Mudcats began play at the Junior A level in the Ottawa City League. This was the first time the boys have played at the A level, and after playing the two top teams in that league on the weekend, the coaching staff is confident that the team will do well.

Goulbourn-Lanark Soccer League Statistics

U9-Girls Tyke					
Rich.Road s4	4	4	0	0	8
Stitts.Hornets	3	2	0	1	5
Stitts.Gaels	3	1	1	1	3
Alm.Angles	4	1	3	0	2
C.P.Harriers	2	1	1	0	2
Mun.Motion	4	0	4	0	0

U9-Major Tyke					
C.P.Buzzards	3	3	0	0	6
Alm.Argos	3	2	1	0	4
Rich.Rebels	3	2	1	0	4
Stitts.Lynx	2	2	0	0	4
C.P.Hawks	3	1	1	1	3

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